

LOW ACID FOODS



Kids (under 10)

Q

Which kitchen tool do grown-ups use to safely can low acid foods like vegetables and meat?

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ANSWER

A pressure canner that gets very hot

FUN FACT

A pressure canner gets hotter than boiling water to keep food safe!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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Q

Why can't low acid foods like green beans be canned using a boiling water canner?

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ANSWER

Because they need extra heat from a pressure canner to be safe

FUN FACT

Low acid foods can hide tiny germs, so they need extra hot pressure to stop them.

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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Q

When a grown-up finishes sealing a jar with foods like vegetables or meat, what do you see happen to the jar's lid after it cools down?

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ANSWER

The lid looks like it's pulled down tight and doesn't pop back up.

FUN FACT

When the lid pulls down tight and stays that way, it helps keep the food inside fresh and safe to eat!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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Q

When canning low acid foods, what do grown-ups have to check on their pressure canner before using it?

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ANSWER

That the pressure gauge and vent are working right

FUN FACT

The pressure gauge helps make sure food cooks safely inside the canner!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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Why do recipes say to vent (let steam escape) the pressure canner before it pressurizes?

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ANSWER

To push out all the air and fill it with super-hot steam

FUN FACT

Getting air out helps the canner get the hottest steam for safe canning!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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Grown-ups add extra pressure to their canner if they live high up on a mountain. Why?

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ANSWER

Because water boils at a lower temperature there, so more pressure is needed

FUN FACT

The higher you go, the cooler water boils, so we turn up the pressure to keep food safe!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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What does a weighted gauge do on a pressure canner?

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ANSWER

It jiggles or rocks to keep the right pressure inside

FUN FACT

The jiggle of the weighted gauge helps keep the pressure just right for canning!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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If a grown-up only uses hot water and not a special big pot to save meat in jars, what might happen to the food inside?

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ANSWER

Some germs might stay and make people feel sick

FUN FACT

A special big pot called a pressure canner gets hotter than boiling water to help keep food safe and yummy!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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If you see bubbles or mold on canned low acid food, what does that mean?

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ANSWER

The food might be spoiled and not safe to eat

FUN FACT

Bubbles and mold are signs food has gone bad and should be thrown away.

Source: PNW 450 Canning smoked fish at home

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Q

How do grown-ups know if a jar made with low acid food is sealed tightly after pressure canning?

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ANSWER

The lid is sucked down and stays flat, not popping up

FUN FACT

A tight sealed lid keeps air out and keeps the food safe inside the jar!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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When canning vegetables which are low acid, what must be added to the jars?

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ANSWER

Hot liquid to cover the vegetables

FUN FACT

Covering veggies in hot liquid helps cook them safely inside the jar.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables

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Which of these is safe to use when canning low acid foods like meat or fish at home?

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ANSWER

A pressure canner made for home use

FUN FACT

Only a special pressure canner can get hot enough to kill germs in low acid foods.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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Why do people have to wait a little while after using the pressure canner before opening the lid?

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ANSWER

Because the canner needs to cool down to be safe to open

FUN FACT

Waiting helps the canner lower pressure slowly for safe opening.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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Q

What happens if jars are packed with too much food before pressure canning low acid foods?

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ANSWER

The food might not heat evenly and may not be safe

FUN FACT

Packing jars just right helps heat reach every part to keep food safe!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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What is a simple way to tell meats and vegetables are low acid foods?

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ANSWER

They don't taste very sour or tangy

FUN FACT

Low acid foods taste less sour because they have less natural acid in them.

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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If you find a jar of home-canned low acid food with a bulging lid, what should you do?

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ANSWER

Throw it away because it may not be safe

FUN FACT

A bulging lid means dangerous germs might be inside-don't eat it!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness

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What does the pressure inside a pressure canner do to help keep low acid foods safe?

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ANSWER

It makes the temperature higher than boiling water to kill germs

FUN FACT

Higher pressure means hotter steam to stop germs from growing in canned food.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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If a grown-up is putting foods like vegetables or meats into jars to keep them safe, what is something they shouldn't do without asking an expert first?

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ANSWER

Change the recipe or how long they cook the jars

FUN FACT

Changing how long jars are cooked or the recipe without help can make the food unsafe to eat!

Source: EM 9152 Safely canning foods

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When canning low acid foods at higher altitudes, what must be done?

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ANSWER

Increase the pressure in the canner to get the right temperature

FUN FACT

Higher places need more pressure so the food gets hot enough to be safe!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

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When a grown-up is using a big metal pot to keep food safe, what sound might you hear from a little metal weight on top?

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ANSWER

A soft rocking or gentle jiggle

FUN FACT

The little metal weight rocks gently to help keep the food safe while it cooks!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game